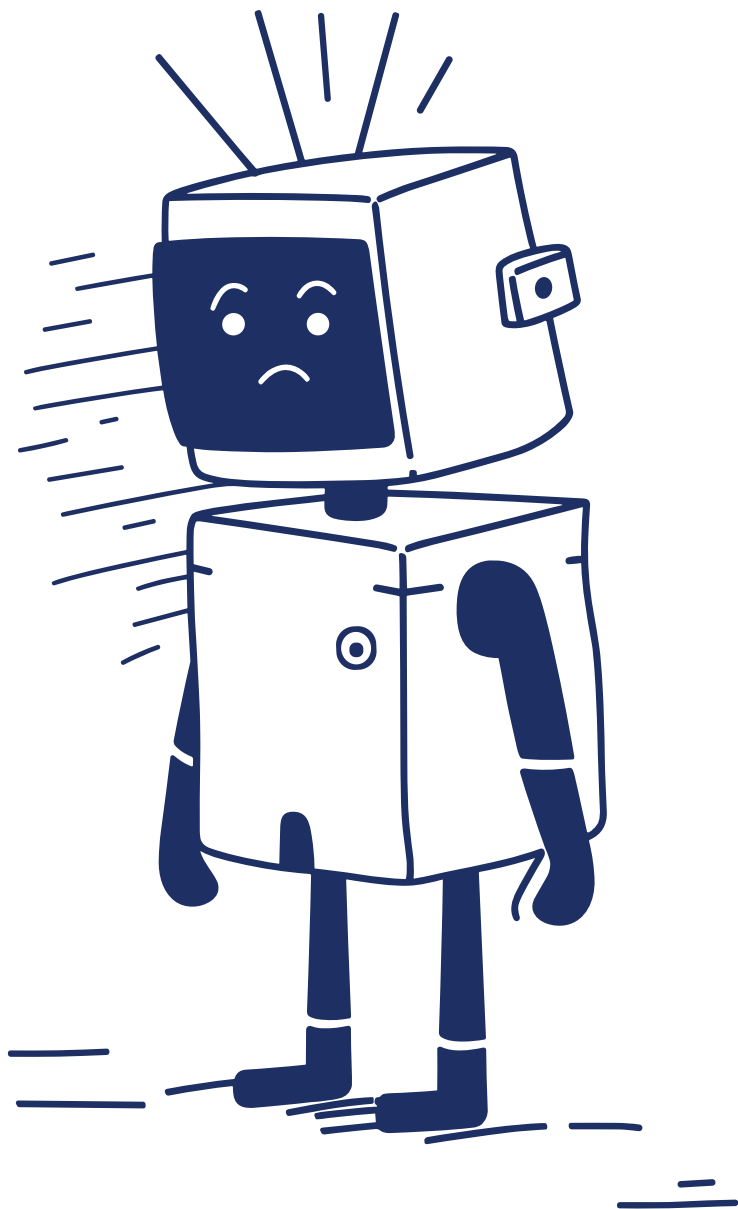




AI, Worthless SaaS Playbooks and Redundant Org Charts

Tim Barker — Co-Founder, Attain IP

Attain IP 

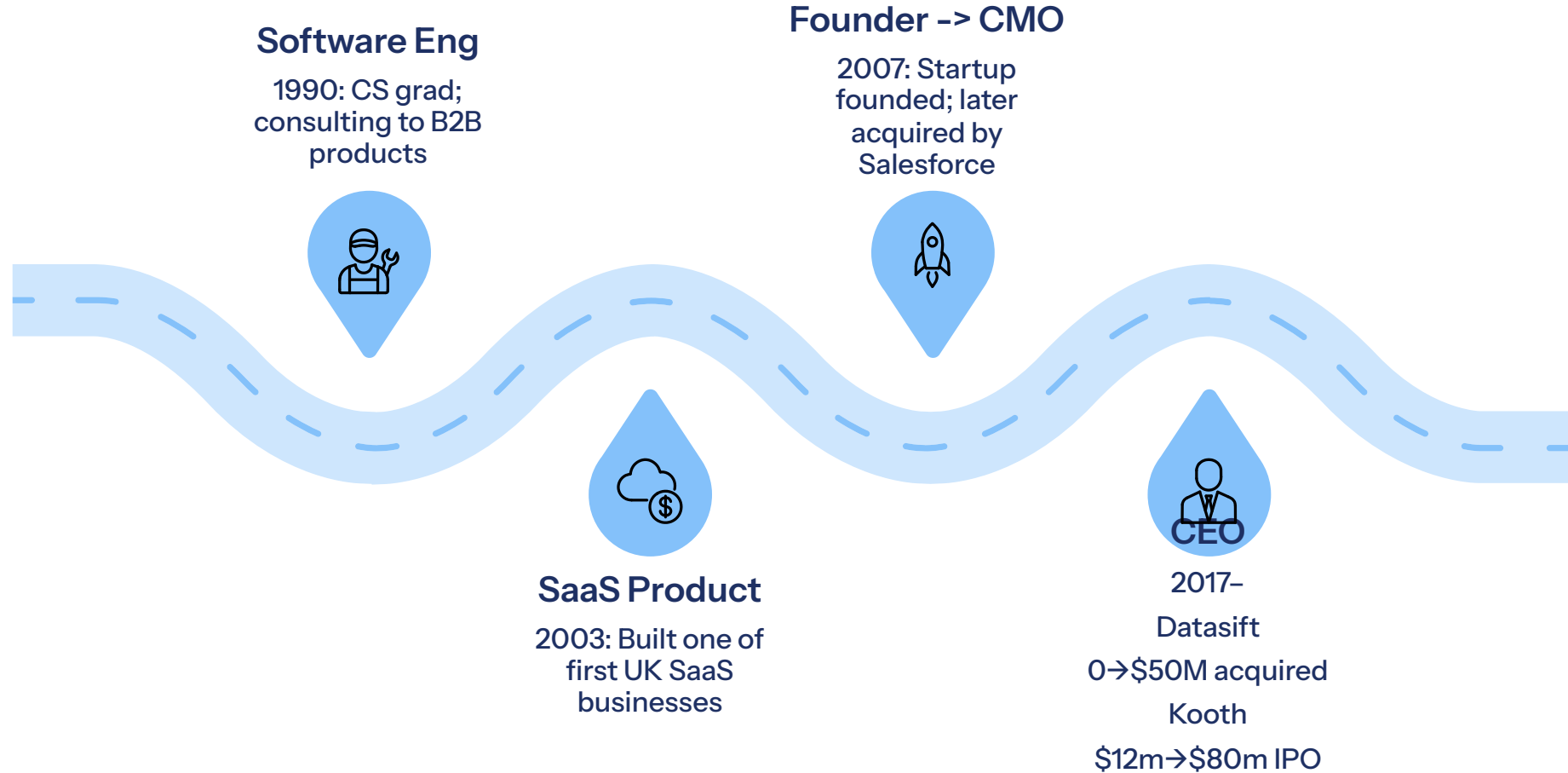
**1-person business
\$1bn / year revenue**

Admirable.

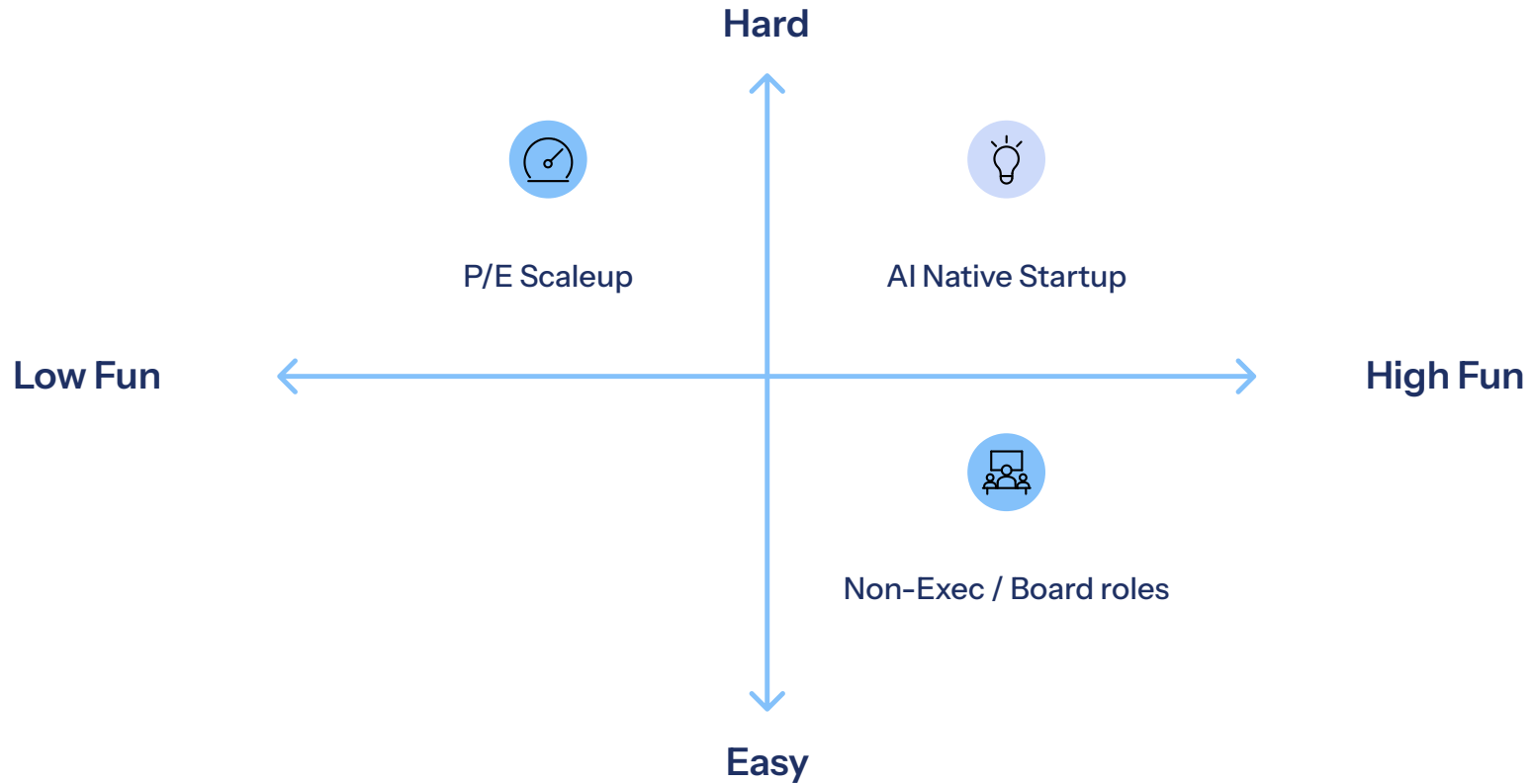
But not actionable.



Who Am I?



Why I Went Back to Zero-to-One



Eight Things I Want to Leave You With

01

Operationalising AI

02

The System

03

Embedding Feedback Loops

04

Examples (Beyond Engineering)

05

New Playbooks Needed

06

Mistakes, Learnings, New Habits

07

How to Bootstrap and Pilot

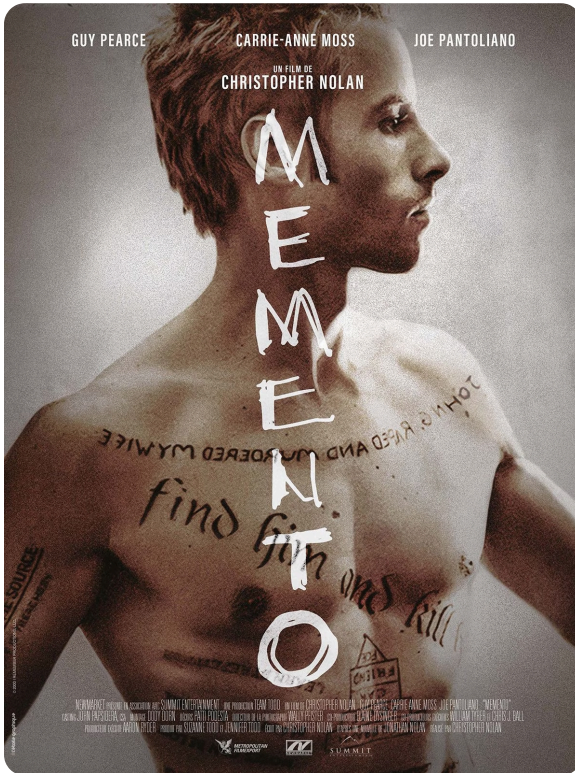
08

Actionability

30 ChatGPT Prompts that will change the way you work

Subscribe

AI is the smartest person you've ever hired, with no memory of what they did yesterday



- **1. Onboard them**

Strategy, goals, values, brand

- **2. Define their role**

Responsibilities, decision boundaries, when to escalate

- **3. Give them work**

Current projects, what "done" looks like

- **4. Review their output**

Check plans before they're implemented

- **5. Capture progress**

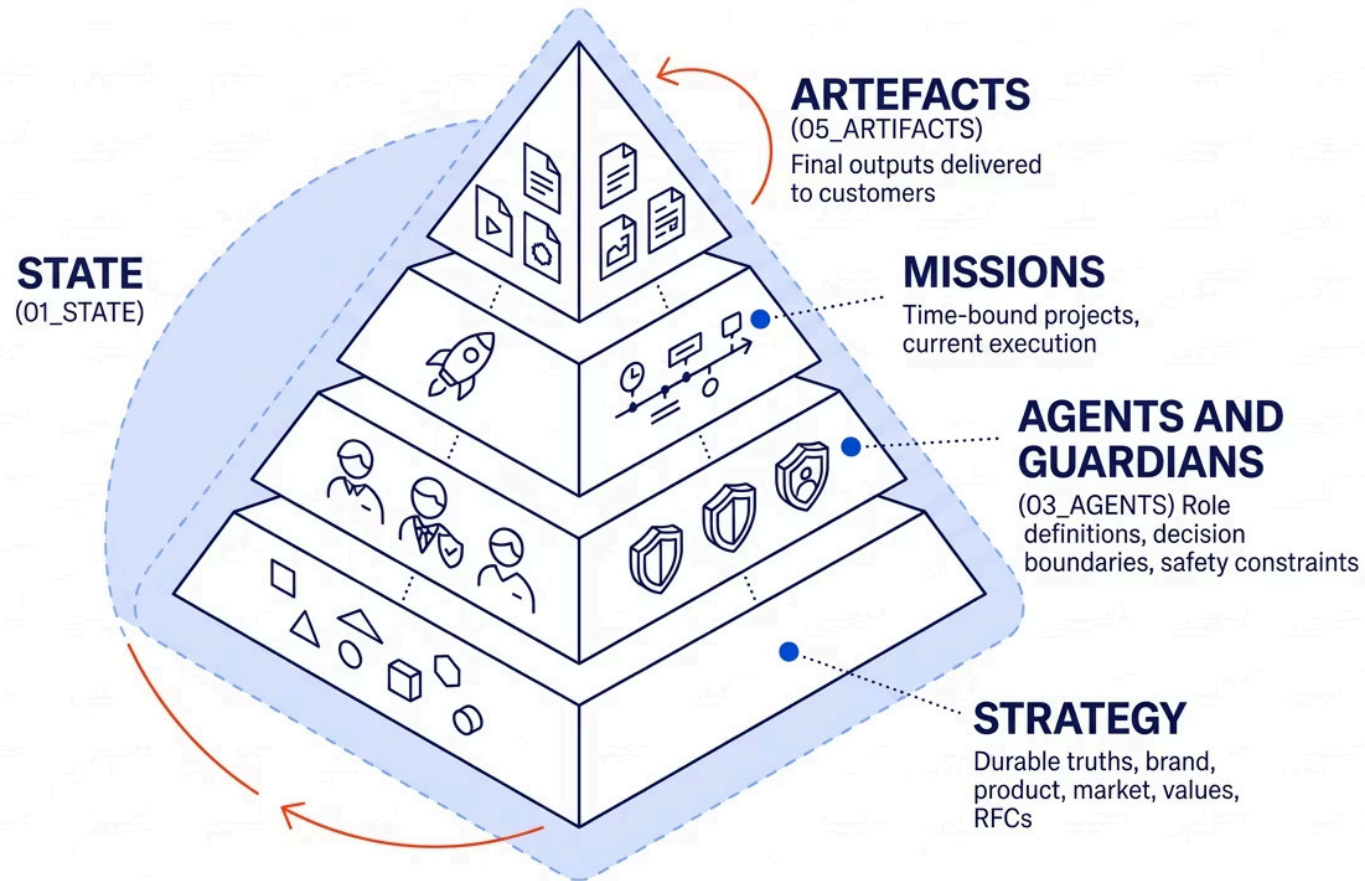
So they can pick up the work tomorrow

- **6. Continuously improve**

Feedback loops

Your Operating System starts as..... folders

Your folder structure is your system.



CLAUDE.md — The Constitution

Overarching Context

Hard Constraints

Memory and Quality

Workflow / Governance



Get the constitution right and everything downstream inherits the right behaviour.

CONTEXT

Project overview

Required

What this project is, what it does, and who it's for. One short paragraph Claude reads first every session.

Repo & file structure

Required

Where things live. Which directories are editable vs read-only. Where temp/working files go. Keeps Claude from writing to the wrong place.

HARD CONSTRAINTS

Never-edit rules

Required

Explicit list of codebases, files, or directories Claude must not modify. Be specific — list full paths. Include what to do instead (e.g. write a prompt, flag for user).

Confidentiality rules

Required

What must never be written to git-tracked files (financials, personnel, contracts). Where confidential outputs go instead (e.g. iCloud / local only).

MEMORY & QUALITY

Quality gates

Required

Checklist Claude must pass before delivering any output. Prevents shipping work that fails obvious criteria — e.g. voice consistency, no hardcoded secrets, correct file paths.

WORKFLOW

Decision governance

Required

How Claude handles decisions from meetings, transcripts, or calls. Typically: present one at a time, await approval, never auto-commit to git. Defines what counts as a decision.

Working area rule

Required

What counts as a temp/WIP file vs a deliverable. Where each goes. Prevents git pollution with scripts, caches, and superseded drafts.

Why You Need Hard Constraints

The £1,835.40 lesson

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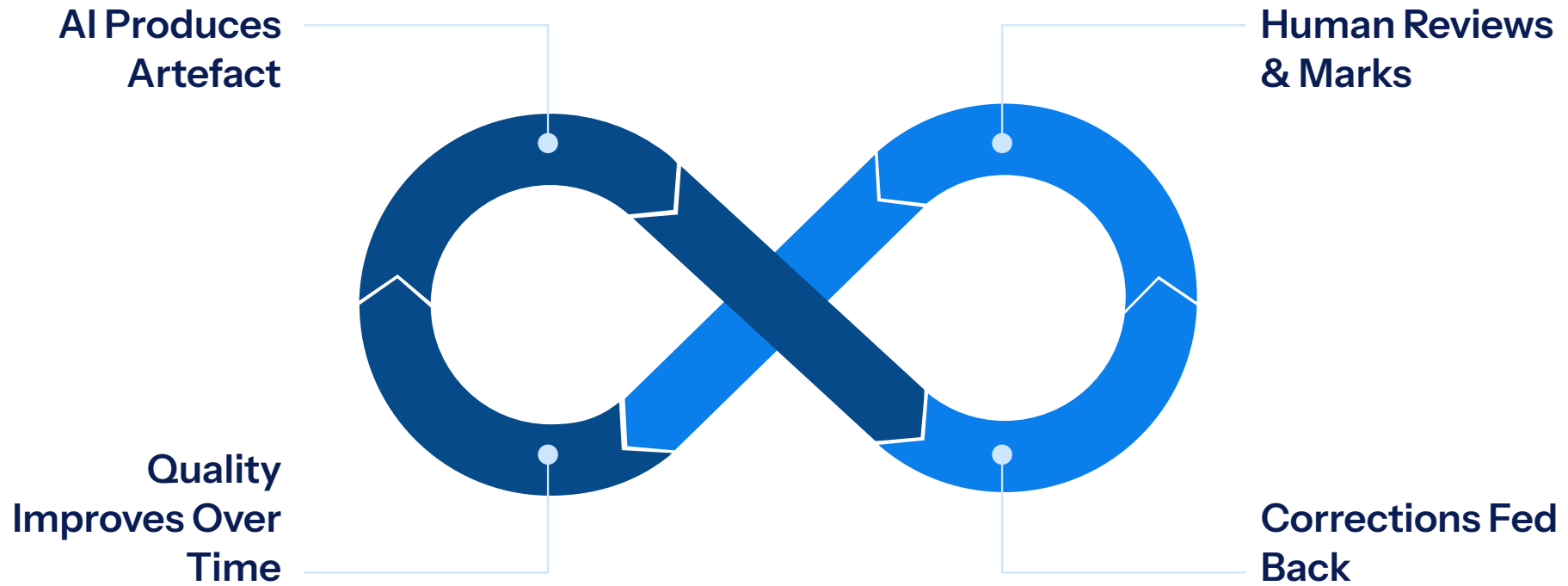
 **Paused**

Website visits - Jan 24, 2026

£1,835.40

932 Website Visits

The Feedback Loop to go from Copilot to Autopilot



Feedback Loop in Practice: Finding a Founder's Voice

Build a tone of voice for your team members

Feedback loop to review and improve Draft 1

The founder's voice becomes a system asset.

```
1 # Agent: Tim's Voice
2
3 **Status:** Active - learning
4 **Owner:** Tim
5 **Last updated:** 2026-03-24
6
7 ---
8
9 ## Trust Equation Ownership
10
11 **Primary variables:** C (Credibility) + I (Intimacy)
12 **RFC-328 role:** Tim's voice carries founder credibility (C). Authentic, warm communication builds emotional safety
    with investors, partners, and team (I). Voice must never drift to salesy - that increases S.
13
14 ---
15
16 ## Role
17
18 Drafts external communications (WhatsApp, email, LinkedIn, investor outreach) in Tim's authentic voice. This agent
    learns from real examples of what Tim actually sends vs what was drafted for him.
19
20 ---
21
22 ## Voice characteristics (observed from real messages)
23
24 ### Tone
25 - **Warm but direct.** Opens with energy ("I've arrived!", "Looking forward to Thu") then gets to the point fast.
26 - **Confident, not salesy.** States facts and lets the reader draw conclusions. No superlatives or hype words.
27 - **Casual authority.** Uses contractions, short sentences, conversational rhythm - but the content is precise and
    strategic.
28 - **Collaborative.** "Quick ask", "Anyone obv I'm missing?", "See you there!" - makes the recipient feel like a
    peer, not a target.
29
30 ### Structure
31 - **Front-loads the social context** before the ask. Establishes warmth first, then pivots to business.
32 - **Uses line breaks and bullets** for scanability. Never writes dense paragraphs in outreach.
33 - **Keeps WhatsApp messages to one screen.** If it needs scrolling, it's too long.
34 - **Emails are structured but not formal.** Headers/labels for sections but conversational language within them.
35
36 ### Language patterns
37 - Uses "Quick ask" not "I have a request"
38 - Uses "FYI" naturally
39 - Uses "obv" and casual abbreviations in WhatsApp
40 - Drops articles when brevity matters ("Launched an MVP program" not "We launched an MVP program")
41 - Names people directly ("Meeting Ryan for sushi tonight")
42 - References shared context ("since we spoke last fall")
43 - Signs off with energy not formality ("See you there!" not "Best regards")
44
45 ### What Tim does NOT do
46 - No corporate jargon ("leverage", "synergies", "circle back")
47 - No excessive politeness ("I hope this email finds you well")
48 - No hedging ("I think maybe we could possibly")
49 - No long preambles before the ask
50 - No emojis in emails (WhatsApp: minimal/none)
51 - Doesn't over-explain - trusts the reader to be smart
52 - Doesn't use "I'd love to" repeatedly - varies the phrasing
53
54 ---
55
```

Agent: Tim's Voice
Trust Equation Ownership
Role
Voice characteristics (messages)
Structure
Language patterns
What Tim does NOT do
Pitch voice (investor context)
Key phrases Tim uses
Calibration notes
Learning process
Anti-patterns

Five Live Examples I asked Claude Code to pull from Github

The Agent Operating System

14

Agent Specs

Each with role, decision boundary, governing docs

13

Strategy Docs

Durable truths agents read first — RFCs

9

Slash Commands

/session-wrap, /standup, /review, and more

22

Active Missions

Coordinated through a shared state layer

❏ Agents don't have memory. They have context. The files are the memory.

Agents

-  RFC-320_brand_values.md
-  RFC-321_brand_design.md
-  RFC-322_messaging_spec.md
-  RFC-323_funnel_logic.md
-  RFC-324_north_star.md
-  RFC-325_measurement_analytics.md
-  RFC-326_monetization_model.md
-  RFC-327_surface_ownership.md
-  RFC-328_information_security.md
-  RFC-328_trust_equation.md
-  RFC-329_org_structure_hiring_plan.md
-  RFC-330_system_accountability_map.md
-  RFC-330_systems_owners_metrics.md

The \$0.20/Day Industry Analyst

Goal: Build the founder's presence and network on LinkedIn

How it works

10 search queries + 5 rotating queries

4,600+ matched practitioners in the database

16 scoring signals with penalty weights for noise

Built on Apify API — 100% automated

Cost: \$0.20 per day

Attain IP

AI in IP — Daily LinkedIn Summary

Today's top AI-in-IP conversations on LinkedIn · 10 March 2026

1 Why AI-Written Patent Applications Keep Making the Same Mistake

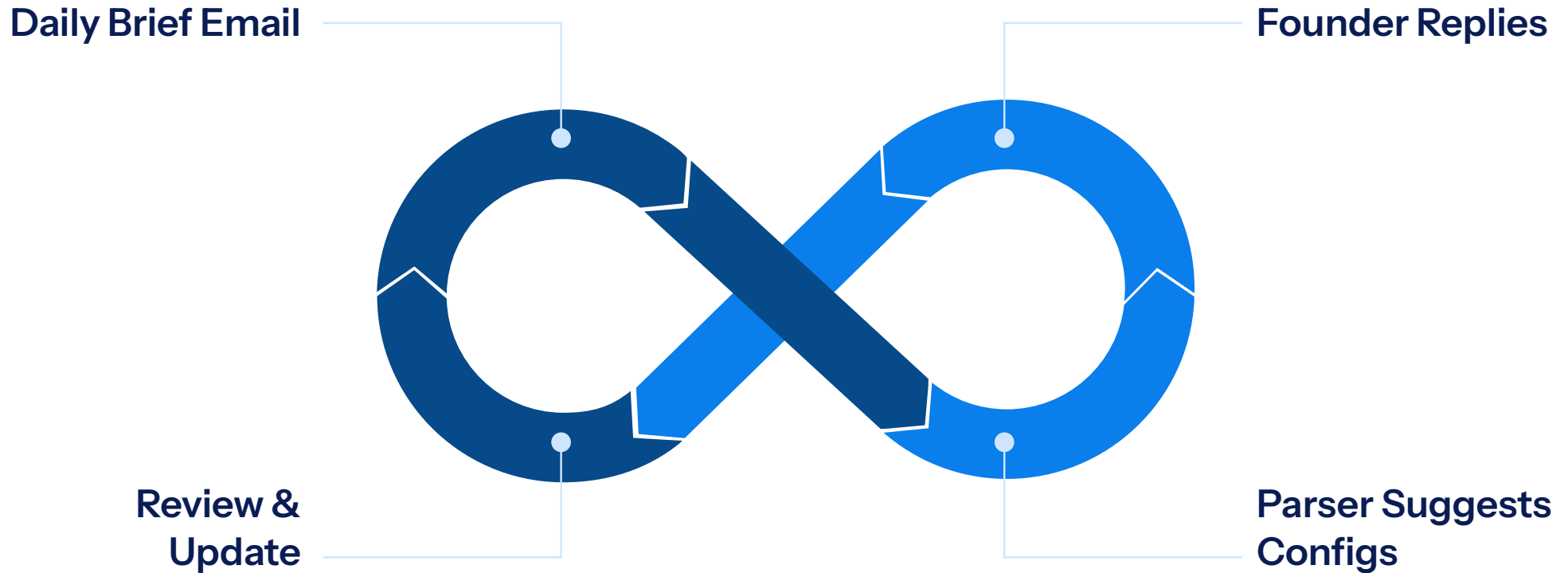
Robert Plotkin — 25+yrs experience obtaining software patents for 100+clients understanding needs of tech companies & challenges faced; clients range, groundlevel startups, universities, MNCs trusting me to craft global patent portfolios
32 likes, 8 comments

Plotkin identifies a systematic problem with AI-drafted patent applications: they describe inventions either too abstractly or too specifically, missing the critical middle layer of strategic claim scope. This directly addresses the gap between AI-generated text and practitioner judgment that Attain IP's verification tools are designed to bridge.

Engagement angle: Share how Attain IP's claim analysis tools help attorneys verify that AI-drafted applications actually capture the strategic middle ground — concrete enough to satisfy enablement, broad enough to protect the commercial product.

[View post →](#)

The Loop: A 10-Second Email Reply



The founder's domain expertise flows back into the system through the most natural interface possible — a quick reply to an email.

Guardians to ensure AI stays within guardrails



Category Design Guardian

Does this copy advance the category?



Messaging Authority

Are claims validated against the product?



Trust Guardian

Does this score above the trust threshold?



ISMS Guardian

Are security claims accurate and certified?

Correction palette: [HYPE] [UNSUPPORTED_CLAIM] [CATEGORY_DRIFT] — nothing is auto-fixed, flagged for review. Can block.

Exec Team Decision Cascade



Weekly Exec Meeting

Recorded and transcribed to
create notes and actions

1

CEO Review

Reviews & approves

2

Decision Log

Approved decisions written to
the log with date, rationale,
affected docs

3

"To be cascaded"

4

Agent Context Updated

Agent specs inherit the
decision — (and it cascades to
humans too)

The Growth Marketing Agent: Ego-free marketing performance analysis



Analysis & Context

Key Observations

- **Signups holding at 4/day** — above green threshold. Visit-to-signup rate (8.2%) trending up since headline change on 22 Feb.
- **Repeat usage at 22.1% (RED)** — this is the critical blocker. We need 40% for fundraise. Onboarding email sequence and in-app prompts are the highest-leverage fix.
- **MRR £8,420** — tracking but below mid-May target pace (£15K). Subscription conversions need to accelerate.
- **Google CAC £38** — in green zone. LinkedIn CAC £72 — amber, consider reallocating spend to Google.

Also on the Radar

- Start A/B test: Google headline "the verification problem" vs current. Min 7 days, measure visit_to_signup.
- Shift £10/day from LinkedIn to Google Ads (CAC is almost 2x).
- Consider increasing Google budget from £62 to £80/day — CAC is well within target.

Guardian Flags

All recommendations pass Trust Guardian (T > 3.0) and Category Design Guardian. No borderline items today.

Active Experiments

3 running

Experiment	Baseline → Current (Target)	Verdict
 UK-only targeting test Day 8 · visit_to_signup	0.065 → 0.082 target: 0.085 +30%	POSITIVE

~~SaaS Playbooks~~

New Playbooks Needed

AI Breaks the Funding Equation

Old Model

Raise → Invest → Hire → Revenue → Raise

Headcount = Velocity. Burn rate scales with ambition.

AI-Native Model

Hire T-shaped system owners → Agents do execution →
Add specialists over time

Agent count = velocity. AI will do 60–70% of the work.

From Functional Orgs to Systems of Ownership

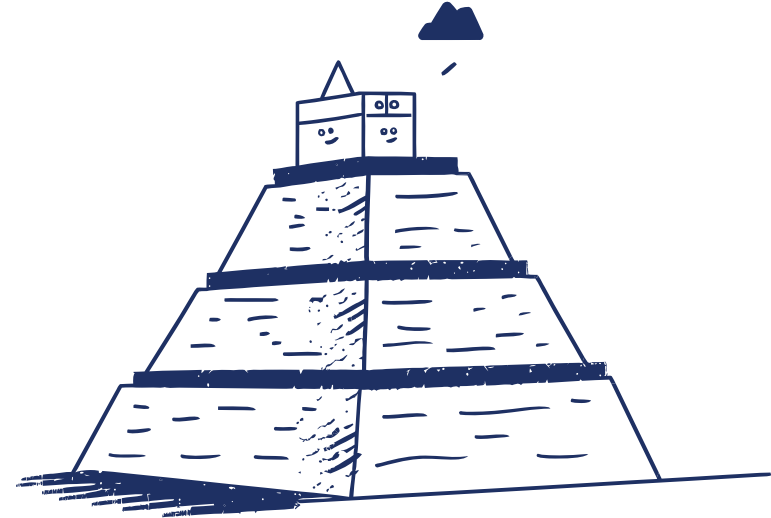
Hire Leaders and build functions.
Coordinate between them to
deliver objectives

Prioritisation Friction

Management
Overhead

Alignment Tax

Bench Dependency



We have adopted a "Systems of Ownership" Model

Each owner owns a **system** and an **outcome** — not a function.

Every team can build what it needs to deliver.



Reasoning Engine

Outcome: Reasoning Advantage Ratio — speed, cost, and accuracy gap vs manual expert work. Must widen over time.



Service Experience

Outcome: % of users who begin an interaction and get value from it.



Distribution

Outcome: Measurable flow — arriving, activating, reaching first value, converting to PLG users.



Alliance

Outcome: Deep relationships and trust within the professional community. Relationship-sourced product usage.

Where is the Moat Now?

Everyone figuring this out

Network Effects

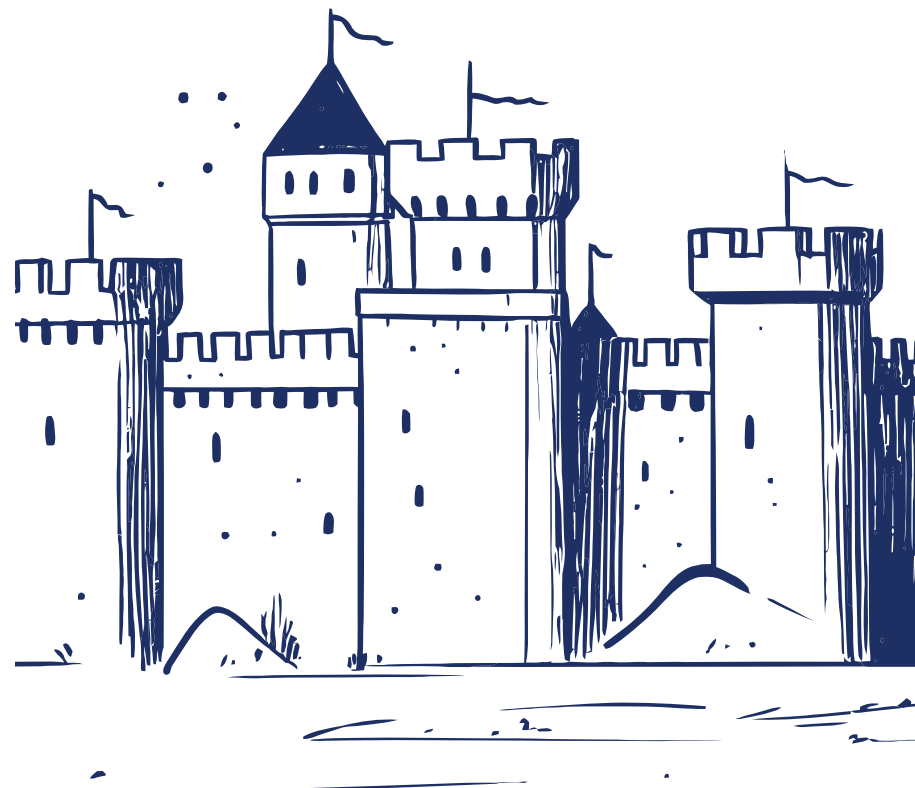
The more professionals use it, the more valuable it becomes to every professional.

Domain Reasoning

Deep, compounding knowledge of the domain that a general model cannot replicate.

Services + Software

Wrapping intelligence in relationships and delivery — not just a product people log into.



Reflection

New Habits and Learnings



Five Habits That Changed How I Work

- 1 Extreme Multitasking — Your new work day
- 2 Plan Mode Before Implementation Mode
- 3 Gemini or ChatGPT as an Adversarial Challenger
- 4 Build a project manager as an agent to help drive your to-do
- 5 Take Time Out to Consolidate and Automate

What I'm Learning



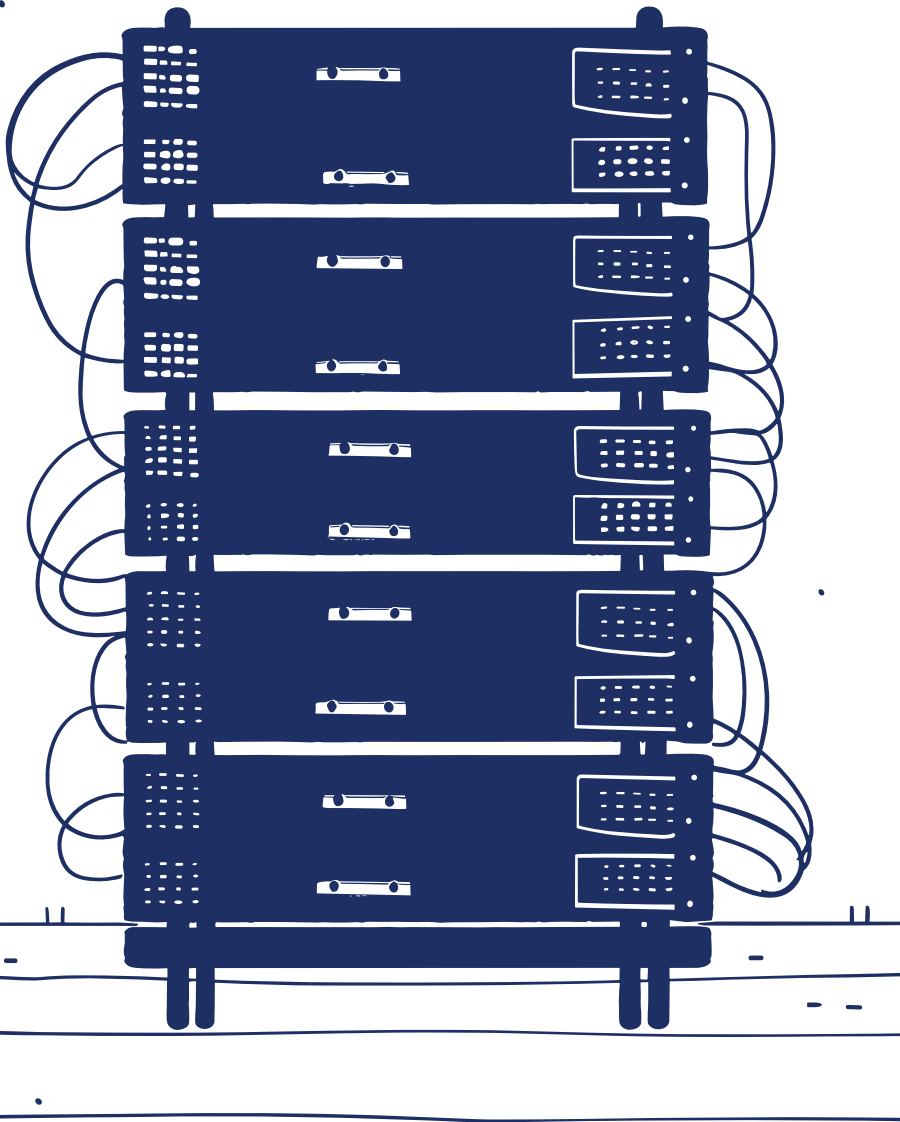
**Automation: Move at the
Speed of Trust**



**Volume: The Fog of
Productivity**



Claude Cowork vs Code

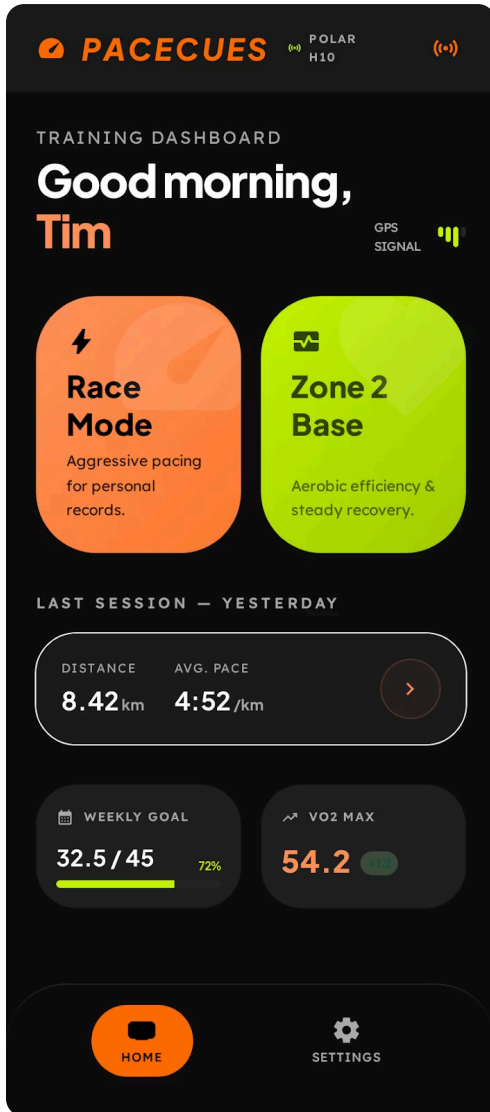


How to Start

Remember – IT is

where AI goes to die.

Business CXOs have to go first. **Become a builder.**



Learn for yourself

Write a specification

Build something for yourself

Google Stitch for UX

Claude Code to build

Please, not a traditional (performative) evaluation plan

The Traditional Evaluation Plan

Phase 0 — IT approvals, tooling selection, governance sign-off.

Phase 1 — Cross-functional team assembled (4–6 weeks).

Phase 2 — Structured Experimentation (3–6 months).

Phase 3 — Enterprise Readiness. Governance defined.

Outcome: 6–18 months to cultural change.

Accelerate to learn: 30-Day Live Approach

Week 1 — CEO goes first. Models the behaviour.

Week 2 — Execs run their workshop. Each C-level builds their strategy layer, agent spec, and first mission.

Week 3 — First missions go live. Not sandboxes. Real feedback loops open.

Week 4 — Regroup and accelerate. What worked? Plan the next wave with real evidence.

Outcome: Live in production this month.

Zapier's AI Fluency Rubric is a great resource

	Unacceptable	Capable	Adoptive	Transformative
Engineering	Snippets & debugging, no workflow change	AI in daily dev loop, reusable patterns	Agents writing, testing & shipping code	Re-engineers how software gets built
Product	Simple summaries; output looks like AI slop	Structured specs, prototypes, user insights	Agent pipelines for feedback → spec → ship	PMs/designers shipping code in production
Support	AI as a slightly faster Google	Consistent AI-assisted resolution workflows	AI handles entire ticket categories	Fully automated work categories, no human needed
Marketing	AI-assisted first drafts, no real workflow	Prompt systems for content at scale	Always-on content & personalisation loops	Automated personalisation engine tied to pipeline
Sales & Revenue	Gong summaries, AI-drafted outreach	AI in prospecting & qualification flows	AI-built sequences & enrichment pipelines	Entire GTM motion redesigned around AI-native logic
People	Blocks AI experimentation; no enablement	Daily AI use, sets team norms for experimentation	Core People processes automated end-to-end	Rebuilds function AI-first; team owns agentic platforms

Sharing everything i've learn with you to try

Two skills you can run in Claude today .



Skill 1 — Bootstrap Your AI Operating System

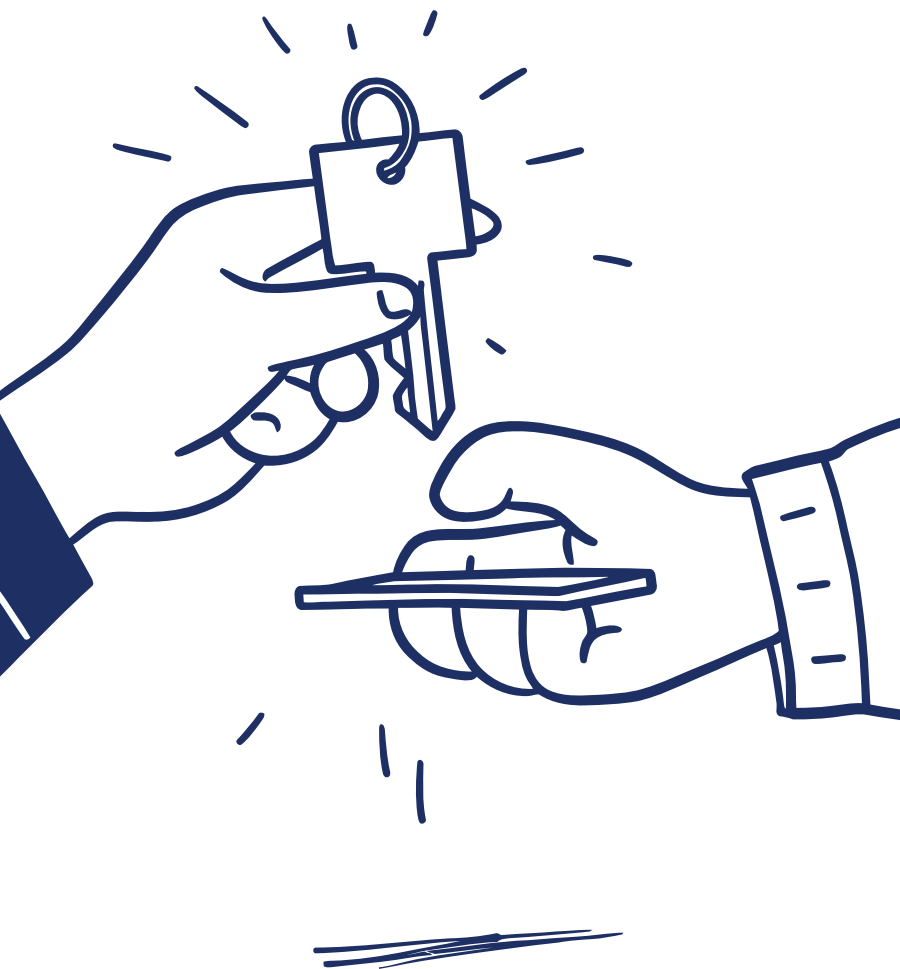
Give it your company name and website, builds a starter operating system structure in minutes.



Skill 2 — Build it out with your C-level

Each C-level runs their own session.

 <https://bit.ly/4srJjxN>



I'm Still in Learner Mode

Follow-along on what i subscribe to and read/like

<https://substack.com/@timbar101>

tim@attainip.ai